



OWNER'S GUIDE • NO. 02

Playing GLIDE

Four rows of keys, played like four strings. The scale is handled for you, so the first thing you press already sounds right. Everything after that is the sliding.

You can't really hit a wrong note.

Every key is a note of the current scale (A minor pentatonic out of the box), so there are no dead keys and nothing to avoid. Press anything. The skill isn't finding the right note; it's how you move between them.

THE FOUR ROWS ARE FOUR STRINGS

STRING 3 • HIGH	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	0
STRING 2	q	w	e	r	t	y	u	i	o	p
STRING 1	a	s	d	f	g	h	j	k	l	;
STRING 0 • LOW	z	x	c	v	b	n	m	,	.	/

← the backing row

Left to right walks up the scale. Each row is a register of its own, and behaves like a string: one voice at a time, gliding between whatever you press on it.

EVERYTHING ELSE, AT A GLANCE

shift (hold)	the notes between: off-scale semitones, only while held	fn + q..p	switch between the ten sounds, live
- / =	octave down / up	alt	the loop pedal (left thumb)
[/]	bend down / up	fn + c	chord mode, in Advanced: every key a whole chord
space	sustain	enter	tilt on / off
bksp	panic: silences everything	tab	settings, and How to play
		ctrl / opt	volume down / up

BASIC NOW, ADVANCED WHEN YOU WANT IT

A new GLIDE starts in **Basic**: the essentials, every key named on screen. Press **tab**: the first row, **Mode**, opens **Advanced**: chord mode, harmony, the sound knobs, every setting. Switching loses nothing. **How to play**, just below it, is the whole manual.

ONE

The sliding is the instrument

Four gestures. The first two take a minute; the third is the one people keep the device for.

HOLD ONE KEY • PRESS ANOTHER ON THE SAME ROW

Hammer-on

The voice *glides* to the new note instead of restarting. No new attack, no click: one continuous line, exactly like sliding a finger up a string.

THEN LET THE SECOND ONE GO

Pull-off

It glides back down to the key you're still holding. Hammer and pull together give you trills, grace notes, and the lazy scoops that make a line sound played rather than typed.

HOLD A SHAPE ACROSS ROWS • RE-FINGER IT SOMEWHERE ELSE

Slide a chord. This is the thing.

Hold two or three keys across different rows, then move that shape while the old notes still ring. Every voice glides to its new home at once. It's the gesture no keyboard can make and the reason the instrument exists.

HOLD SHIFT

The notes in between

Pure chromatic semitones for as long as you hold it. The scale keeps you safe; **shift** is how you earn the notes it was protecting you from. It's momentary on purpose: let go and you're back on safe ground.

WHAT THE SCREEN IS TELLING YOU

The big trace is the **pitch trail**: pitch drawn over about seven seconds, gridlines on the root, so every glide is a visible curve.

Settings → *Display* swaps in the **waveform**, the real output.

top left	the sound's name (* if unsaved)
next to it	key and scale
top right	OCT <i>n</i> : which octave you're in
beside it	CHORD or HARM, WAH, SOLO while on
under the trace	tilt slider, loop, chord chips

TILT

Tilt is on out of the box. Lean the device forward and back to morph toward the sound you were last on; tilt it side to side for vibrato. It is never pitch bend: that's what **[** and **]** are for. **enter** turns it off and on. Settings → *Tilt feel* picks one of four ready maps; *Tilt center* teaches it where *your* flat is.

TWO

The sounds are yours

Ten sounds sit on **fn** + **q** .. **p**, switchable while you play. Eight are a curated bank. The last two are not like anyone else's.

O AND P ARE ROLLED FOR YOUR DEVICE ALONE

Those two slots are generated from a seed created on your Cardputer's very first boot, so no other unit on Earth has them. They aren't stored: they're re-derived from that seed every time, which is why a factory reset brings them back exactly as you know them.

ROLLING YOUR OWN

Press **tab** for settings: **Randomize** and **Mutate** are the two big buttons at the top. Every action auditions itself on the spot with a short lick, so you can judge two rolls by ear.

Randomize	A whole new sound, and a whole new <i>kind</i> of sound. Each roll commits to a character first (a pluck that stops, a bell that rings, a pad that swells, an acid squelch, a wobble bass, a bowed string section, or pure chaos), then paints inside that character's bounds. Guardrails mean a roll is never dead, blown out, or off-key. Roll until you love one.
Mutate	Don't start over: evolve what you have. Gentle keeps the character and nudges it; wild rewrites it (<i>Mutate amt</i> , in Advanced, sets which). Sculpting toward a vibe instead of pulling a slot machine.
Undo / Redo	Every roll and mutate checkpoints first. You can always step back to the sound you just had, so nothing you liked is ever one tap from gone.
Init sound	A blank, neutral sound to build up by hand (Advanced).

KEEPING WHAT YOU FIND

Fast: onto a slot. **fn** + **shift** + **q** .. **p** saves the live sound over that slot. Your ten favourites, always a chord away.

A * in the switch list marks a slot holding a sound of your own.

Unlimited: onto the card. Settings → **Save to SD** writes a **.gpat** file, offering the sound's own auto-name (*warm-haze-3f*); press **enter** to keep it or type your own. **Load from SD** browses the whole library back.

No card? The instrument plays perfectly without one.

NOTHING YOU SAVE IS AT RISK FROM AN UPDATE

Slots, settings and card files all live outside the program, in a format built to be added to rather than replaced. Installing a new GLIDE cannot touch them. See Owner's Guide No. 01.

THREE

One hand backs, the other solos

Something to play over. It lasts until you clear it or power off, and never touches saved sounds.

TAP CHORDS ON THE BOTTOM ROW, IN ORDER

A chord progression, spelled with no timing at all

Tap chords in order on the bottom row: four taps for I-IV-V-IV, no timing needed. The clock loops them one per bar, gliding between them, while you solo on top. Each is a real triad from the scale.

ADVANCED: SETTINGS → JAM MOTION: SUSTAINED

Drones, held under you

The bottom row latches instead: tap a key and it rings an octave down until you tap it again. Lay down a root and a fifth and solo above; your bends and vibrato move only the solo.

FN + A · UP, DOWN, UP/DOWN, OFF · ADVANCED: FN + Z RATE, FN + X SPAN

The arpeggiator: the same chords, one note at a time

fn + **a** breaks the bottom row's chords into notes, root-3rd-5th-octave in time, walking your progression. A texture, not a mode: no key changes meaning, and it is off again on every restart.

ALT · TAP: COUNT-IN, THEN RECORD · TAP: LOOPS FROM THE BAR LINE · TAP: OVERDUB

The loop pedal

It records the *performance*, not the audio, and keeps the sound you recorded it on: loop a bassline, switch to a lead, and solo over it. In chord mode it records the whole chord. Hold **alt** to clear.

CHANGE YOUR SOUND OVER A RUNNING JAM AND THE SPLIT APPEARS

Switch patches while a backing plays and it *keeps* its sound; the new one is your solo voice. Octave too: only the solo moves. **SOLO** in the top bar marks the split; **bksp** clears everything.

IF A SONG IS PLAYING IN THE ROOM

Hold **fn** + **k** and GLIDE goes quiet and **listens**, finds the song's key from a few seconds of it, and retunes to fit. Close but not quite? Tap **space** on the result card for the next likely reading.

Go and play it. That's the whole point.

The full manual and other players' sounds live online. The Discord is where to share yours, and to find me if you're stuck.

github.com/CHARL3X/GLIDE-Synth-Cardputer-ADV
discord.gg/uRcuJGCeHG



SCAN · THE REPO



SCAN · THE DISCORD